

The Tathāgata Candraprabha

Candraprabhatathāgata · Toh 868 · Derge Kangyur

ཟླ་འོ་འདྲི་དེ་བཞུགས་པ་དག་གཅེས་པ་ཡང་དག་

The Recollection of the Name of Candraprabha, whose Tibetan title begins with the words for the Tathāgata Moonlight, the arhat, is a very short scripture centered on the buddha Candraprabha, whose name means "Moonlight." It is Toh 868 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī and protective-formula texts, though I cannot confirm the full Sanskrit and Tibetan titles from the lines given here. The text opens with a homage to the Tathāgata Candraprabha and then offers a brief mantra, which invokes the buddha, dharma, and saṅgha as sources of blessing. It concludes with a promise of benefit: anyone who rises early each morning and calls the buddha's name to mind will remember their past lives over forty thousand eons and will not fall into the lower realms. In this way the text presents the simple practice of recollecting a buddha's name as a means of protection and spiritual merit.

Homage to the Tathāgata Candraprabha, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha!

Tadyathā, candre candre, sucandra, maticandra, candrakiraṇa, siri siri, buddha adhiṣṭhite, kili kili, dharma adhiṣṭhite, kili kili, saṅgha adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

Any son or daughter of good family who always rises early in the morning and calls to mind the name of the Tathāgata Candraprabha will remember their past lives over forty thousand eons, and will not fall into the lower realms. Through recollecting the name of Candraprabha, one will obtain these qualities.

Here ends the Recollection of the Name of Candraprabha.

Translator's Notes

- The Tathāgata's name, Zla ba'i 'od, means "Moonlight" and is rendered by its Sanskrit form, Candraprabha. The mantra is given in its Sanskrit transliteration, slightly normalized; siri siri follows the Tibetan spelling.

Colophon

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human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.